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Stone weights

1.6.2 Stone weights

References:

Hebrew אֶבֶן (’even) LEV 19:36, DEU 25:13, DEU 25:13, DEU 25:15, 2SA 14:26, PRO 11:1, PRO 16:11, PRO 20:10, PRO 20:10, PRO 20:23, PRO 20:23, MIC 6:11

Greek σταθμίον (stathmion) SIR 42:4

Description and usage:

Stone weights (© Chamberi, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons)Stones of various sizes and weights were used on balance scales to determine the price of produce being sold (see 1.6.1 Balance scales<REALIA:1.6.1>). The stones were usually marked with their weights.

Translation:

In most of the references above, the weights are a means of determining the amount to be paid for something; that is, they are a tool for conducting business dealings. So in some of the passages the reference to weights may be left implied; for example, in PRO 16:11CEV has "The LORD doesn't like it when we cheat in business."

While the Hebrew word *'even* literally means "stone," in the references listed above, where the translator decides to indicate the physical object, it will normally be best to translate *'even* as "weight."